

5. TAKE A DEFENSIVE DRIVING COURSE

Every few years, you have the opportunity to enroll in a defensive driving course for a discount of 10-20% off your insurance premium. These courses generally last between four to twelve hours, and are offered through local driving schools, private companies, employee programs, or even online through DefensiveDriving.com. A class about safe driving habits might be a really boring way to spend your day, but it also helps save money!

One word of caution—before you sign up for *any* class, call your insurance company and be sure they accept whatever course you’re taking. Thankfully, defensive driving classes aren’t too expensive (I’ve seen prices anywhere from \$25-\$75), but I’d hate for you to pay that money and not have it lower your insurance after all.

6. RESEARCH THE COMPETITION

Gathering quotes from a variety of car insurance companies will give you the leverage you need to negotiate better rates. Take some time to compare prices, and don’t forget to include any of the perks or discounts available with that particular company. It might help to create a spreadsheet so you can see everything side by side, but I also say that because I’m slightly obsessed with spreadsheets!

Researching quotes is time-consuming, but practicing our due diligence and comparing information from other companies allowed us to find a six-month policy for \$371. This saved us a total of \$135.50 from the 2013 bill I mentioned in an earlier example.

Price is an important factor, but also keep an eye on customer satisfaction. And don’t be swayed by “limited time offer” conditions. Buying car insurance should be a carefully thought out process that allows you time to consider all alternatives. Walk away and choose someone else if you feel too pressured to commit.